Humana. **Claims Payment Policy**

Subject: Laboratory – β-Hemolytic Streptococcus Testing

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
Policy number: LAB2023025
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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.

In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

- Bacterial culture testing (CPT code 87081, CPT code 87070, CPT code 87071) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** in cases of viral pharyngitis.
- Amplification testing (CPT code 87651) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** in cases of viral pharyngitis.
- Rapid antigen diagnostic testing (RADT) (CPT code 87880) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** for any of the following:
  - As a follow-up test to bacterial culture test (CPT code 87081, CPT code 87070, CPT code 87071) for a *Streptococcal* infection within the prior 14 days
  - In cases of viral pharyngitis
- Serological titer testing (CPT code 86060, CPT code 86215) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** in patients with *Streptococcus*.
- Direct probe testing (CPT code 87650) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE** if amplification testing (CPT code 87651) for *Streptococcus* has been performed on the same date of service.
- The following tests **ARE NOT REIMBURSABLE** in patients with *Streptococcus* or *Enterococcus*:
  - Anti-streptolysin O immunoassay (CPT code 86060, CPT code 86063)
  - Tests that screen and identify multiple *Streptococcal* strains, using either immunoassay or nucleic acid-based assays, such as the Solana Strep Complete Assay and the Lyra Direct Strep Assay (CPT code 83789, CPT code 87430)
- The quantification of any strain of *Streptococcus* using nucleic acid amplification, including polymerase chain reaction (PCR), (CPT code 87652) **IS NOT REIMBURSABLE.**

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure code	Code description
83789	Mass spectrometry and tandem mass spectrometry (e.g., MS, MS/MS, MALDI, MS-TOF, QTOF), non-drug analyte(s) not elsewhere specified, qualitative or quantitative, each specimen
86060	Antistreptolysin 0; titer
86063	Antistreptolysin 0; screen
86215	Deoxyribonuclease, antibody

Procedure code	Code description
87070	Culture, bacterial; any other source except urine, blood or stool, aerobic, with isolation and presumptive identification of isolates
87071	Culture, bacterial; quantitative, aerobic with isolation and presumptive identification of isolates, any source except urine, blood or stool
87081	Culture, presumptive, pathogenic organisms, screening only;
87430	Infectious agent antigen detection by immunoassay technique, (eg, enzyme immunoassay [EIA], enzyme-linked immunosorbent assay [ELISA], fluorescence immunoassay [FIA], immunochemiluminometric assay [IMCA]) qualitative or semiquantitative, Streptococcus, group A
87650	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Streptococcus, group A, direct probe technique
87651	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Streptococcus, group A, amplified probe technique
87652	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); Streptococcus, group A, quantification
87880	Infectious agent antigen detection by immunoassay with direct optical (ie, visual) observation; Streptococcus, group A

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